

Business Continuity Plan (BCP)

Sanwo - Fintech Case Study

Digital Payments & Financial Services Company

Prepared by: *Zainab Taofeek*

Introduction

This Business Continuity Plan (BCP) defines how Sanwo will maintain and restore critical operations during and after disruptive incidents such as cyberattacks, system failures, or physical infrastructure destruction.

The plan ensures that Sanwo continues to deliver secure and reliable financial services while protecting customer data, maintaining trust, and meeting regulatory expectations.

Company Overview

Sanwo is a fictional fintech company that provides:

- Digital payment processing
- Mobile wallet services
- Peer-to-peer money transfers
- Online merchant payment solutions

As a financial technology provider, Sanwo operates in a high-risk environment where service availability and data integrity are critical.

Objectives of the BCP

The objectives of this plan are to:

- Ensure continuous availability of critical financial services
- Minimize service disruption during emergencies
- Protect customer funds and sensitive financial data
- Restore operations within defined recovery time objectives (RTOs)
- Maintain customer trust and regulatory compliance

Scope

This plan covers:

- Core payment and wallet systems
- Mobile and web applications
- Cloud infrastructure and databases
- Customer support operations
- Third-party payment integrations
- Internal IT and security systems

Business Impact Analysis (BIA)

Business Function	Description	Impact of Downtime	Recovery Time	Data Loss Tolerance	Priority
Payment Processing	Handles all customer transactions	Financial loss or customer Data satisfaction	1-2 hours	5 minutes	Critical
Wallet Services	Stores customer balances	Inability to access funds	2 hours	10 minutes	Critical
User Authentication	Login and identity verification	Users cannot access platform	1 hours	5 minutes	Critical
Merchant Gateway	Enables business payments	Revenue loss for merchants	2-4 hours	15 minutes	High
Customer Support System	Ticketing and support services	Slower response time	24 hours	24 hours	Medium

Risk Scenarios

Risk Event	Description	Likelihood	Impact	Affected Area	Mitigation control
Ransomware Attack	Systems encrypted by malware	Medium	Very high	Core payment systems	Backups, EDR, MFA, patching
Cloud Outage	AWS/Azure service disruption	Low	High	Entire platform	Multi-region failover
DDoS Attack	Traffic overload on servers	High	High	APIs, login systems	WAF, rate limiting, CDN
Database Failure	Corruption or crash of DB	Medium	Very high	Transactions, wallet data	Replication, backups
Third-party API Failure	Payment provider downtime	Medium	High	Payment gateway	Redundant providers
Insider Threat	Malicious employee action	Low	High	All systems	Access control, monitoring

Continuity Strategies

Sanwo will implement:

- Multi-region cloud deployment for redundancy
- Real-time database replication
- Automated failover systems
- Daily encrypted backups stored offsite
- Secondary disaster recovery environment
- Manual transaction logging during system downtime

Activation Plan

The BCP is activated when:

- Critical systems are unavailable for more than 30 minutes
- Cyberattack or data breach is confirmed
- Infrastructure failure affects core services

Steps:

1. Incident detection and reporting
2. Notification of BCP response team
3. Activation of disaster recovery systems
4. Switching traffic to backup environment
5. Communication to stakeholders

Roles and Responsibilities

Office	Responsibility
BCP Manager	Oversees activation and coordination
IT Team	System recovery and infrastructure restoration
Security Team	Incident containment and forensics
Operations Team	Service continuity support
Customer Support	Customer communication and updates
Executive Management	Decision-making and escalation approval

Communication Plan

During disruptions, Sanwo will use:

- Internal alerts (Slack/email/SMS)
- Customer status page updates
- Pre-approved notification templates
- Regulatory reporting channels (where required)

Communication will be clear, timely, and transparent.

Recovery Procedures

- Restore systems from latest backups
- Activate disaster recovery environment
- Validate system integrity and security
- Gradually restore transaction processing
- Monitor system performance post-recovery

Testing and Maintenance

- Quarterly disaster recovery drills
- Annual full BCP simulation exercises
- Continuous plan updates after incidents
- Staff training and awareness programs

Third-Party Dependencies

Sanwo relies on:

- Cloud service providers (AWS/Azure/GCP)
- Payment gateways
- SMS/email notification providers
- Banking settlement APIs

All third parties must meet agreed SLAs.

Conclusion

This Business Continuity Plan ensures that Sanwo can maintain critical financial services during disruptions while minimizing downtime, financial loss, and reputational impact.